



Citizens' Report

14th National Assembly of Pakistan 1st Parliamentary Year

June 01, 2013 – May 31, 2014



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Printed in Pakistan

Published: August 2014

ISBN: 978-969-558-430-9

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PREFACE

The 14th National Assembly of Pakistan has been voted in through Pakistan's 10th General Election held on May 11, 2013. It officially completed its first year on June 01, 2014. In keeping with the PILDAT tradition of compiling and disseminating National Assembly's performance on a periodic basis since 2002, the current report also looks at some of the main categories of legislative performance.

The Citizens' Report on the Performance of the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan covers the period of June 01, 2013 to May 31, 2014. Now that the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan has completed its 1st year, it is all the more opportune time to highlight its performance and recommend reforms to improve its overall performance.

The report highlights key areas of concern, milestones and improvements required in various key performance indicators. The report has been divided in three parts. **Part 1** states some basic facts related to the National Assembly of Pakistan in order to set the context for the report. **Part 2** looks at various statistics related to the National Assembly of Pakistan in order to gauge quantitatively its performance. **Part 3** presents a strategic analysis of the performance of the National Assembly along with stating the major challenges faced and the required reforms to improve the performance of the legislature.

Disclaimer

This report has been prepared using the information and data from public sources. PILDAT team has made every effort to ensure accuracy of data and content in this report and any omission or error is therefore, not deliberate.

Islamabad
August 2014

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The 14th National Assembly of Pakistan completed its 1st Parliamentary Year on May 31, 2014. The National Assembly met for a total of 130 days by holding 11 sessions, spread over the entire year. It met the constitutional requirements of meeting at least for a 100 Working Days. In total, the National Assembly worked for 322 Hours at an average of 29 hours each session.

The raging conflict that has spilt on the streets of Lahore and Islamabad in August 2014 once again indicates that the National Assembly of Pakistan has failed to become the legitimate forum for resolution of political and national conflicts. The Assembly, by virtue of an apparent lack of importance both by the Government and the Opposition, remained unsuccessful in providing workable recommendations on resolving Pakistan's key issues.

On what appears now to be a “pressing” issue of required electoral reforms in Pakistan, neither the Parliamentary leadership of the PTI, which repeatedly, throughout the 1st Parliamentary Year, accused the PML-N of indulging in electoral malpractices, cared not to present a comprehensive set of required electoral reforms to the Assembly, nor the Government used the legitimate forum of the National Assembly throughout the first year to systematically address the critical issue. An analysis of Private Members Bills reveals that during the 1st year, the PTI merely resorted to asking for an amendment to the Representation of the People's Act, 1976 by calling for the inclusion of Returning Officer's in the list of respondents in a petition regarding electoral malpractices and the appointment of serving judges of the High Court as arbiters in the Election Tribunals.¹ On the other hand, the Government, which first offered to form a Parliamentary Committee on Electoral Reforms in August 2013,² did not follow through on its promise until after the completion of the 1st year of the 14th National Assembly and nearly a year after it first made such a promise.

As has been the practice over the years, on major issues facing the country, instead of being the main repository of policy review and advice, the national legislature largely remained outside the policy loop and vital issues were seldom presented or seriously discussed in this forum. Energy, for instance, which was cited as one of the most pressing problems of Pakistan by the people,³ was not debated by the Government in the House. While the PML-N Government unveiled a National Energy Policy 2013-2018,⁴ the policy was not presented by the Prime Minister to the House for discussion.

In his inaugural speech as Prime Minister of Pakistan on June 4, 2013, Mr. Muhammad Nawaz Sharif identified various areas of concern which he said that his Government would ardently pursue. This included economic and political development along with efforts aimed at improved and mutually beneficial foreign relations. It is interesting to note that the National Assembly's legislative activity was not reflective of this as any significant legislation pertained only to

1. Please see details at: The Representation of the People (Amendment) Act, 2014. Available for download from the 'Private Members' Bills Laid' section of the National Assembly website; can be accessed at http://www.na.gov.pk/uploads/documents/1399367436_709.pdf
2. On August 15, 2013, during a sitting of the National Assembly, the Federal Interior Minister Chaudhary Nisar Ali Khan, MNA, responding to the concerns of Pakistan Tehrik-e-Insaf (PTI) presented in a Calling Attention Notice regarding rigging in the May 11, 2013 General Election, said that a Special Committee of the House should be constituted to investigate the matter in its entirety and furnish proposals for electoral reforms. The Interior Minister said that the Committee should be given a timeframe of one month to complete its findings and proposals and should be fully authorized to summon the former Caretaker Prime Minister and Caretaker Chief Ministers in order to expose the truth to the public. He said that those involved in rigging should be de-seated. He also said that the Government and Opposition should point out 20 constituencies each to examine whether any rigging was done there. On the occasion, the Leader of the Opposition Syed Khurshid Ahmad Shah, MNA, welcomed the Government's decision to form a Committee on Election rigging and Electoral Reforms. PTI leader Shah Mehmood Qureshi, MNA said the issue was raised by his party chief Imran Khan and his party had no objection on the formation of a committee. Upon this, the Deputy Speaker Mr. Murtaza Javed Abbasi, MNA, asked the heads of the parties to nominate their members for a meeting after three days on the terms of reference of the committee. However, after this announcement, the formation of the Committee hit a snag and the nomination of the members by the political parties was delayed beyond the set deadline. On October 10, 2013, the Minister for Science and Technology, Mr. Zahid Hamid, MNA, while chairing the Inter-Provincial Roundtable on Required Electoral Reforms by PILDAT said that a Parliamentary Committee on Electoral Reforms is to be constituted soon. Eventually, on June 11, 2014, after the completion of the 1st Parliamentary Year of the 14th National Assembly, the Prime Minister wrote to the National Assembly Speaker, asking him to constitute a Special Parliamentary Committee comprising members of the two Houses of Parliament to take up the issue of electoral reforms. It was only on July 26, 2014, nearly a year after the idea of the Committee was floated by the Government, that the Speaker National Assembly constituted a 33-member Parliamentary Committee on Electoral Reforms.
3. Please find details at: IRI Survey: <http://tribune.com.pk/story/628369/iri-survey-for-most-pakistanis-power-crisis-is-the-real-problem/>
4. Please see details at: Pakistan's new energy policy, The Express Tribune, August 6, 2013. <http://tribune.com.pk/story/587273/pakistanis-new-energy-policy/>

improving the extant legal infrastructure dealing with terrorist activities. With regards to improved foreign relations, debates were held in the National Assembly regarding the skirmishes with Indian forces along the Line of Control, attacks on the mausoleums in Syria, and the use of force by Egyptian security forces against protesters opposing the removal of a democratically elected Government. The Kashmir issue remained on the backburner, with a motion moved by the Jamaat e Islami (JI) under Rule 259, calling upon the House to discuss the Government's Kashmir policy but it was not taken up.

In a welcome development, however, on June 24, 2013, Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif made a policy announcement at the floor of the House regarding his Government's decision to proceed with the High Treason case against the former Chief of Army Staff / President General (Retired) Pervez Musharraf. Opposition leaders from the PPP and the PTI extended their support to the Prime Minister. The treason trial, which ended up indicting Gen. (Retd.) Musharraf, has been the first of its kind in Pakistan relating to the imposition of emergency rule by Gen. (Retd.) Musharraf on November 3, 2007.

Furthermore, Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif also announced on January 29, 2014 on the floor of the Assembly that his Government would pursue peace talks with Taliban militants naming a four-member committee to facilitate the talks. Prime Minister said that he would personally supervise the performance of the Committee, adding that he was sincerely trying to restore peace in the country and expressed his hope that the other side would reciprocate in a similar manner.

After nearly 9 months of the formation of Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif's Government, the first National Internal Security Policy of Pakistan was presented in the National Assembly of Pakistan on February 26, 2014. Despite the delay, it was not only commendable that a policy was unveiled, but also that the Government, after the nod of the Federal Cabinet, presented its key features to the National Assembly.

The attendance of members continued to be a problem over the 1st Parliamentary Year of the 14th National Assembly. There was a **lack of Quorum 21 times** while the Prime Minister of Pakistan, **Mr. Muhammad Nawaz Sharif**, only appeared **7 times** to participate in the National Assembly sittings. This constitutes to be a presence of 2% only by the Prime Minister in the 1st year of the current National Assembly. The Prime Minister's absence from the National Assembly was also mirrored by other national leaders such as Mr. Imran Khan, MNA, PTI; Maulana Fazlur Rahman, MNA, JUI-F and Chaudhry Pervaiz Elahi, MNA, PML, among others, who were not present on more than 12 sittings of the 14th National Assembly.

Citizens, however, have to strain to get the above information as the National Assembly continues to deny them the basic right of providing record of attendance of each Member of the National Assembly. PILDAT, which has been struggling for greater transparency in Parliament, has repeatedly asked the National Assembly to provide for record of attendance of individual members publicly. PILDAT finally asked for the National Assembly members' attendance record invoking the Freedom of Information Ordinance, 2002. After the request was declined by the National Assembly Secretariat, PILDAT appealed to the Wafaqi Mohtasib (Federal Ombudsman) which, after holding proceedings for the past many months, upheld PILDAT's point of view and "recommended" (that's all the ombudsman can do) to the National Assembly in its "Findings and Recommendations" of 30th September 2013 to provide the requested attendance records. The National Assembly may choose to file an appeal against this verdict with the President of Pakistan where such appeals are known to sit for years. But one should hope that better sense will prevail and the National Assembly Secretariat, under the new Honourable Speaker, will turn a new leaf and make the MNAs' attendance record public. No positive developments, however, have been made in this regard during the first year. It is important to point out here that daily attendance records of Indian Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha are regularly displayed on their respective websites and so is the practice in most other Parliaments around the world.

Despite repeated demands, the Assembly also failed to institute a specific Question Hour for the Prime Minister while this is a Parliamentary tradition around the World.

In a welcome development, the Honourable Speaker National Assembly announced the introduction of a transparent and merit-based hiring process in the National Assembly Secretariat through the Federal Public Service Commission (FPSC). The decision, according to the Honourable Speaker, was made to re-structure the National Assembly Secretariat driven by the three-pronged objective of merit, task-identification and the economy. This has been a long-standing reform proposal to route the recruitment in all Parliamentary Secretariat through the FPSC. This decision,

announced by the Honourable Speaker, would lead to transparent and merit based recruitment whereby the best applicants would secure jobs in the National Assembly. PILDAT has recommended that the much-needed initiative should also be made part of the Recruitment Rules of the National Assembly of Pakistan to ensure that the process is made permanent and is also followed by subsequent Assemblies. There is a need that the change in recruitment rules is adopted by all legislatures across Pakistan. In addition, promotions of the Assembly Staff should also be made subject to their successful completion of courses at the National School of Public Policy in order to better train and increase the performance of the staff. It is worth noting that the Senate of Pakistan is already sending officers on training in the institutions to enhance the management and decision making capacity of the parliamentary staff at both the middle and senior levels.

In a welcome development, the 14th National Assembly, upon the conclusion of the first year of its term, presented its own performance report highlighting various aspects of its working while enlisting various reforms that have been underway upon the initiative of the new legislative leadership.⁵

The publication of this report by the National Assembly is indeed a milestone towards greater transparency and public access.

The report identifies various reforms that have been undertaken during the first year. These include the development of a **Strategic Plan 2013-2018** putting forward required reforms to make the Assembly more effective, efficient, respected and well informed; setting up of a **Project Management Unit** in July 2013 to monitor, evaluate and streamline donor activities under a central coordination mechanism and the introduction of **Human Resource reforms** to enhance staff capability management. The report highlights that efforts to create a Legislative Council in the Parliament under the Strategic Plan 2013-2018 are underway to improve the in-house capabilities of drafting legislation. The report also adds that in order to develop Human Resource with regards to the Legislative Drafting Unit, the Honourable Speaker has invited 26 universities and education institutes to offer courses of parliamentary studies. The Assembly is also considering ICT Reforms to move towards a greater paper-less Parliament and the introduction of Management Information System.

Perhaps the most important in the reform proposals identified has been **Reforming PIPS**. The report states that the Pakistan Institute of Parliamentary Services (PIPS) was revitalized in order to make maximum use of this valuable facility. In this regard, a new Board was constituted which brought vibrancy by holding 6 meetings during this year and developing a KPI and activity based annual business and work plan.

During the 1st Parliamentary Year, the 14th National Assembly received **22 Government Bills and 43 Private Members' Bills**. Of these the Assembly has passed 11 Government Bills so far. This also includes the Federal Budget for the year 2013-2014. However, none of the 43 Private Members' Bills were passed.

3 of the Government Bills passed pertained to the dealing with terrorist activities in the country and were aimed at amending and enhancing the existing legal regime. The Anti-terrorism (Amendment) Act, 2014, for example, conferred powers of investigation upon the Rangers, provided legal cover to the Joint Investigation Team, and introduced special provision for protection of witnesses in terrorism related cases. Similarly, the Protection of Pakistan Act, 2014 made provisions for speedy trial of offences committed by non-State actors.

The Assembly missed the deadline to form Standing Committees by more than a month and a half in violation of Rule 200 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business of the National Assembly of Pakistan. The formation of 29 Standing Committees of the National Assembly was approved in the fourth session on August 21, 2013 exceeding the limit of 30 days. One commendable development has been the continuation of the tradition of appointment of Chairpersons of the Standing Committees in proportion of the parties' representation in the National Assembly. This has resulted in 15 Chairpersons belonging to the ruling PML-N, 4 to the PPPP, 3 to the PTI, 3 to the PML, 2 to the MQM and 1 to the PMAP and the JUI-F each. Furthermore, in keeping with the commendable tradition set during the 13th National Assembly of Pakistan, the Leader of the Opposition, Syed Khurshid Shah, MNA, PPPP, was elected as the Chairperson of the all-important Public Accounts Committee (PAC).

5. Please see details at: Performance of 14th National Assembly: www.na.gov.pk/uploads/1402379841_443.pdf

Similarly, for the first time in Pakistan, after considerable bipartisan reform⁶ efforts by PILDAT over the years, Standing Committees in the National Assembly began to scrutinize ministerial budget proposals ahead of their inclusion to the Federal Budget. This was made possible through a reform, passed in the shape of an amendment in the National Assembly Rules allowing Standing Committees' to review Public Sector Development Programme (PSDP) budget of each Ministry/Division ahead of its inclusion in the Annual Budget.

Overall, there were no significant reforms⁷ introduced in the **Budget** process that lasted for only 17 working days. Members merely went through the motions of the Budget to place their approval on it. MNA participation saw a 20% decline in the 2013-2014 Budget Session in comparison to the previous (13th National Assembly) of Pakistan where, on average, 169 Members participated in each of the 5 Budget sessions. A 12.2% increase in the time spent debating the Budget compared to the average time spent in all of the Budget sessions of the previous Assembly was also observed.

6. Please see details at: PILDAT Background Paper: Parliamentary Budget Reforms in Pakistan:
http://www.pildat.org/Publications/publication/budget/ParliamentaryBudgetReformsinPakistan_Feb2013.pdf
7. Please see details at: PILDAT report: Assessment of the Quality of Democracy in the First 100 Days of the National and Provincial Governments, June 6 – September 13, 2013:
http://www.pildat.org/publications/publication/SDR/AssessmentoftheQualityofDemocracyinFirst100daysofNationalandProvincialGovernments_Sep2013.pdf

PART-I

14th National Assembly of Pakistan

Basic Facts

14th National Assembly of Pakistan: Basic Facts

The National Assembly is a democratically elected body consisting of a total of 342 members who are referred to as Members of the National Assembly (MNAs), of which 272 are directly elected members and 70 reserved seats for women and religious minorities.

On March 17, 2013, the 13th National Assembly was dissolved on completion of its five-year term under Article 52 of the Constitution. The General Election 2013 (for the 14th National Assembly) was held on May 11, 2013. Members of 14th National Assembly took oath on June 1, 2013. The 14th National Assembly completed its 1st Parliamentary Year on May 31, 2014.

Current Members

Total strength of the house is **342**. As of May 30, 2014, there are **336** members as **6** seats are vacant where the seats are either withheld or terminated or waiting re-poll.

Party Position

There are 18 political parties⁸ in the Assembly while independent candidates take 8 seats. They are summarized as under:

Figure 1: Province wise Distribution of the Members of the National Assembly

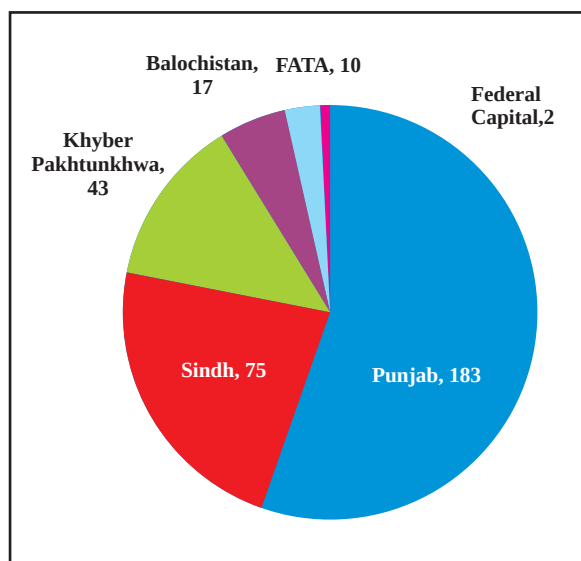


Table 1: Political Party Representation
(In alphabetical order)

Political Party	Number of Seats
Awami Jamhuri Ittehad Pakistan (AJIP)	1
Awami Muslim League (AML)	1
Awami National Party (ANP)	1
All Pakistan Muslim League (APML)	1
Balochistan National Party (BNP)	1
Independents	8
Jamaat e Islami (JI)	4
Jamiat Ulema e Islam – Fazl (JUI-F)	15
Muttahida Qaumi Movement (MQM)	23
National Party (NP)	1
National Peoples Party (NPP)	3
Pakistan Muslim League (PML)	2
Pakistan Muslim League – Functional (PML-F)	6
Pakistan Muslim League – Nawaz (PML-N)	186
Pakistan Muslim League – Zia (PML-Z)	1
Pakistan Peoples Party Parliamentarians (PPPP)	42
Pakistan Tehreek e Insaf (PTI)	35
Pashtoonkhwa Milli Awami Party (PMAP)	4
Qaumi Watan Party – Sherpao (QWP-S)	1
Withheld/Terminated/Re-poll	6
Total	342

8. Party-Wise Graph of the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan as give on the National Assembly Website; it can be accessed at <http://www.na.gov.pk/en/party-stats.php>

PART-II

Performance of the
14th National Assembly of Pakistan
1st Parliamentary Year

Performance of the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan

With the conclusion of its 1st Parliamentary Year on May 31, 2014 the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan has in these initial 12 months, attended to its normal business of law making and oversight, apart from the following performance indicators.

Key Performance Indicators

Working Days & Hours

According to Article 54 (2) of the Constitution of Pakistan, the National Assembly has to meet for a minimum of 130 days in a year. The 14th National Assembly, during its 1st year met for a total of 130 Working Days by holding 11 sessions, spread over the entire year (showing a decline of 9.7% in comparison to the number of Working Days of the last year of the previous Assembly.) In total, the National Assembly worked for 322 hours at an average of 29 hours per each session.

The actual (excluding breaks or non-Working Days) number of days the Assembly met for was 103 during the 1st Parliamentary Year. The previous (13th National Assembly of Pakistan), in comparison, had met on a combined average in 5 years for 103 days per Parliamentary Year.

Working Days of the Budget Session

The Annual Budget Statement is generally presented at the National Assembly during the second week of June and is passed by the National Assembly by the beginning of last week of June. This process generally leaves 15 to 20 calendar days for the various stages of Budget debates in the National Assembly. Table 2 shows the number of days allocated for Budget debate in the National Assembly from 1998 till 2014.

The second session of National Assembly, lasting from June 12 to June 28, 2014 was spent on the introduction and passage of the Federal Budget 2013-2014.

No significant reforms⁹ were introduced in the Budget process that lasted for only 17 working days. Members merely went through the motions of the Budget to place their approval on it. MNA participation in the Budget Session saw a 20% decline in the 1st Parliamentary Year for the 14th Assembly in comparison to the

Budget Session of the previous (13th National Assembly) of Pakistan where, on average, 169 Members participated in each of the five Budget sessions. A 12.2% increase in the time spent debating the Budget in the 1st year of the 14th Assembly compared to the average time spent in all of the Budget sessions of the previous Assembly was also observed.

The newly elected Government presented its first Federal Budget in the 14th National Assembly at the time when more than two-thirds of the members were present in the first sitting. The Federal Minister for Finance, Revenue, Economic Affairs, Statistics and Privatization, Senator Ishaq Dar, PML-N, presented the Budget during the first sitting of the second session.

The Prime Minister and the Leader of the Opposition were present during the sitting. A maximum of 303 legislators (89% of the total membership) were observed to be present at one point of the sitting. A total of 246 (72%) Members were present at the outset of the sitting, while 255 (75%) at the end of the sitting. All ten minority Members were present during the sitting.

There was a serious lack of pre-Budget consultation with the members and the general public. A mechanism of consultation could have been beneficial in terms of a democratic consensus on Budget allocation. The Federal Budget 2013-2014 was passed in a remarkably short amount of time (17 working days) further indicating lack of substantive discussion on the crucial document.

Constitution of the National Assembly Standing Committees

The formation of 29 Standing Committees of the 14th National Assembly was approved in the fourth session on August 21, 2013 after a delay of almost one and a half month. It is important to note that this was a clear violation of Rule 200 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business of the National Assembly which states that the Standing Committees need to be instituted within 30 days of the election of the Leader of the House.

The structure of all 29 Standing Committees, 6 Non-Ministerial Standing Committees, 3 Parliamentary Committees, the Finance Committee of the National Assembly and the Special Committee on the Kashmir Issue was completed in the 1st Parliamentary Year, as

9. Please see details at: PILDAT report: Assessment of the Quality of Democracy in the First 100 Days of the National and Provincial Governments, June 6 – September 13, 2013: http://www.pildat.org/publications/publication/SDR/AssessmentoftheQualityofDemocracyinFirst100daysofNationalandProvincialGovernments_Sep2013.pdf

Figure 2: Comparison of Sessions of National Assembly

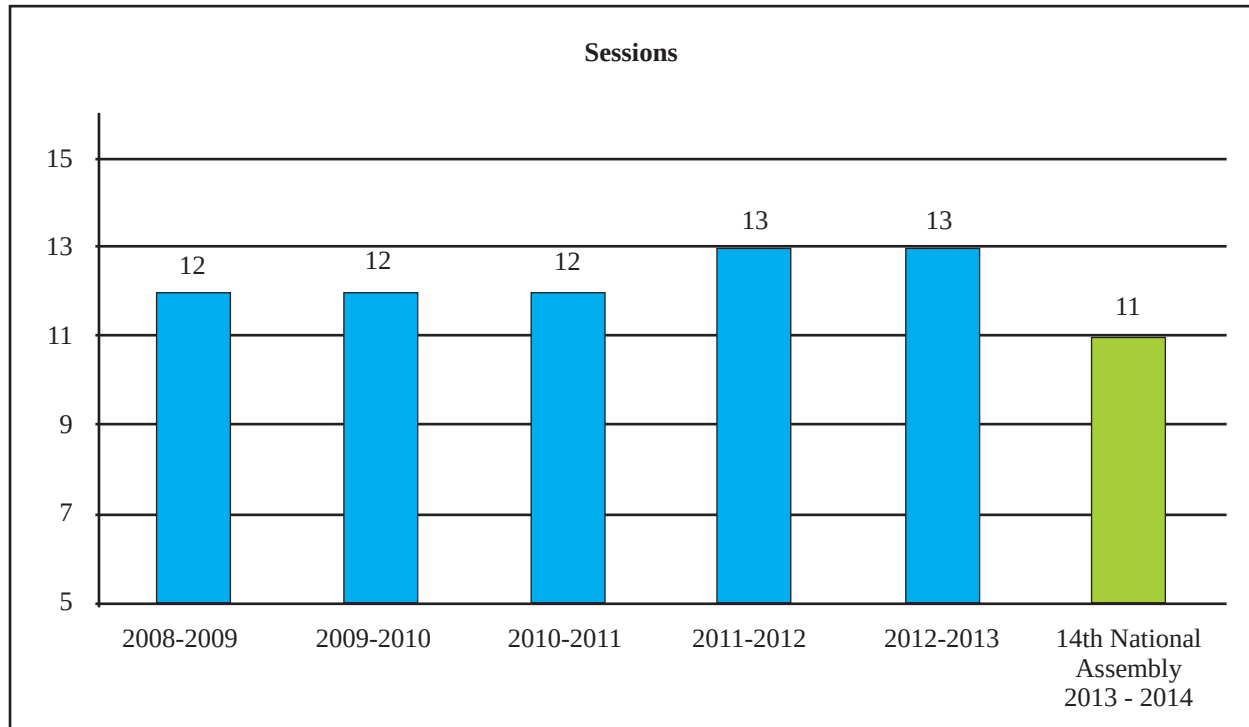


Figure 3: Comparison of Working Hours in the National Assembly

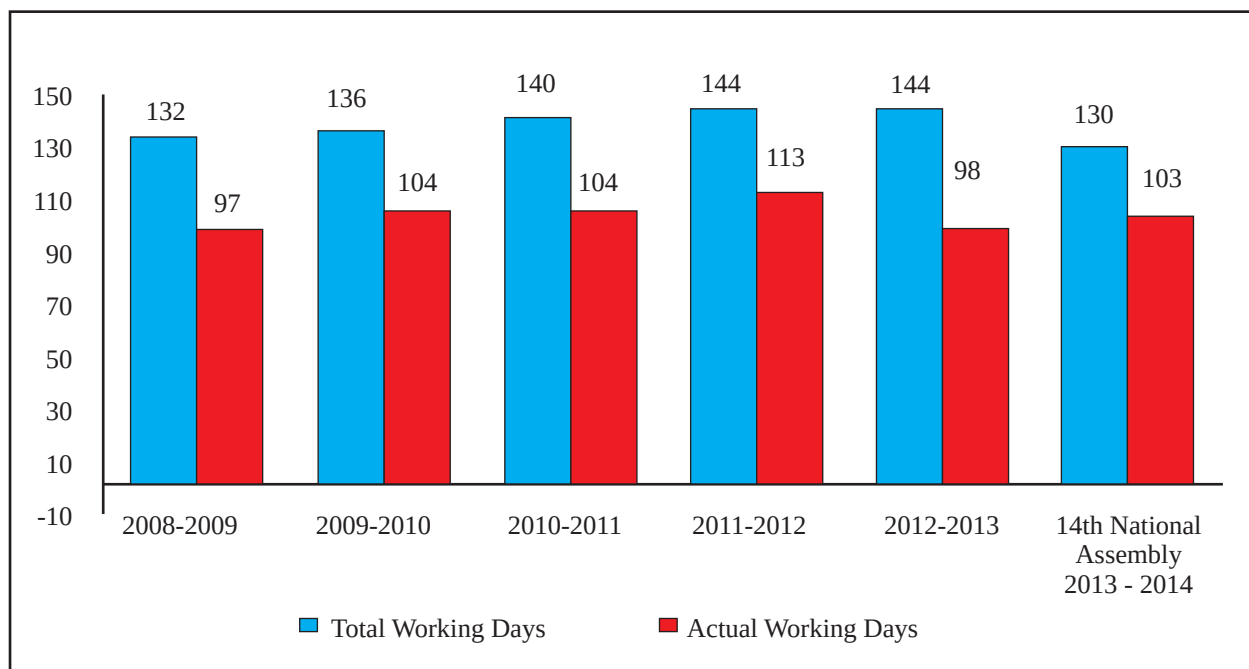
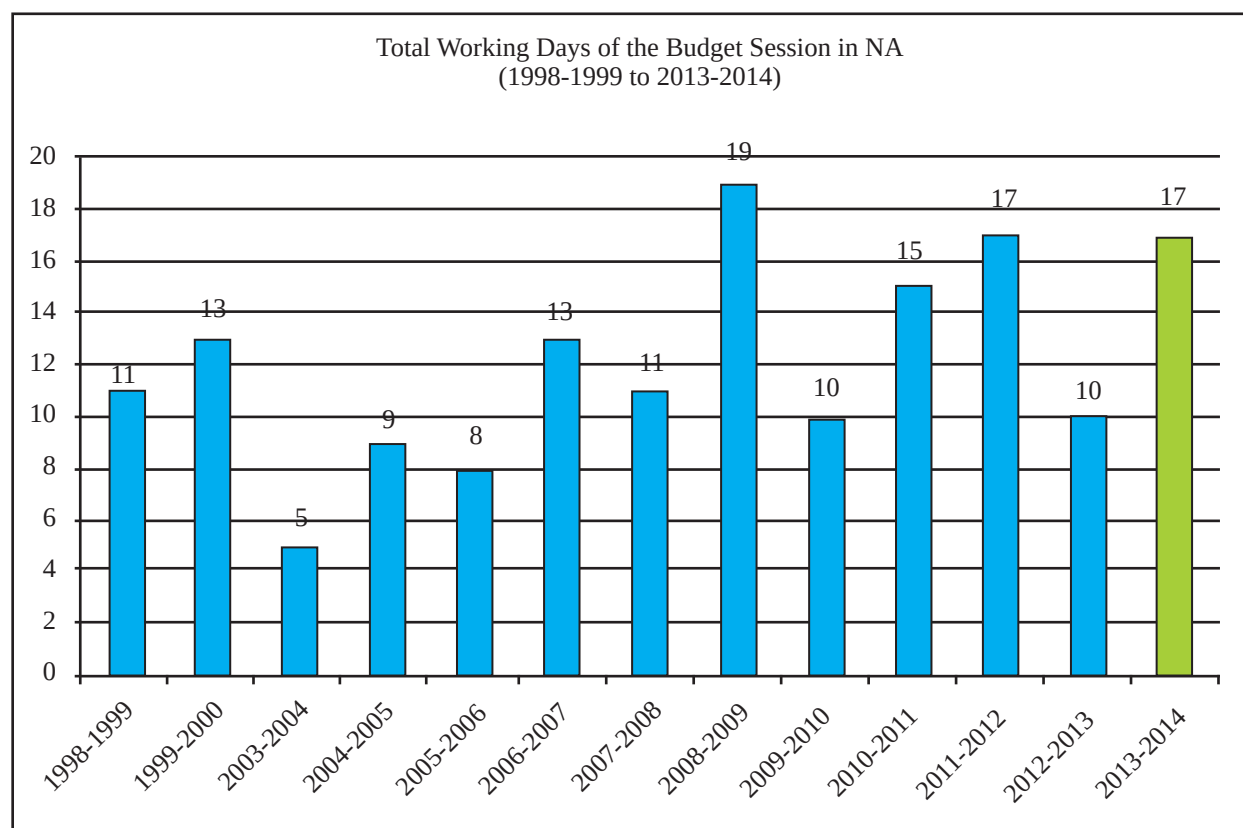


Table 2: A Comparison of Budget Debate Sessions in the National Assembly: 1999 to 2014

	1998-1999	1999-2000	2003-2004	2004-2005	2005-2006	2006-2007	2007-2008	2008-2009	2009-2010	2010-2011	2011-2012	2012-2013	2013-2014
Total Working Days of the Budget Session	11	13	5	9	8	13	11	19	10	15	17	10	17
Number of Members Participated	80	66	48	191	132	183	187	229	170	161	139	147	135
Time Consumed in the Budget Session	17.00 Hours	13.50 Hours	09.40 Hours	45.32 Hours	34.20 Hours	55.50 Hours	45.22 Hours	41.46 Hours	42.00 Hours	39.00 Hours	35.00 Hours	25.50 Hours	41.06 Hours

Figure 4: Comparison of Working Days of the Budget Session in National Assembly



per the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly, 2007. All Committee Chairs have been elected and almost all Committees have held their meetings at an average rate of 8.32 per Committee during the first year. Both Chairs and Members were elected in proportion to respective strength of each Parliamentary Party in the House. A total of 19 Reports have been prepared by different Standing Committees, out of which 10 Reports have been presented to the Assembly. A list of Standing Committees can be found in Appendix I in the Table 5.

One commendable development has been the continuation of the tradition of appointment of Chairpersons of the Standing Committees in proportion of the parties' representation in the National Assembly. This has resulted in 15 Chairpersons belonging to the ruling PML-N, 4 to the PPPP, 3 to the PTI, 3 to the PML, 2 to the MQM and 1 to the PMAP and the JUI-F each. Furthermore, in keeping with the commendable tradition set during the 13th National Assembly of Pakistan, the Leader of the Opposition, Syed Khursheed Shah, MNA, PPPP, was elected as the Chairperson of the all-important Public Accounts Committee (PAC).

Similarly, for the first time in Pakistan, after considerable bipartisan reform¹⁰ efforts by PILDAT over the years, Standing Committees in the National Assembly began to scrutinize ministerial budget proposals ahead of their inclusion to the Federal Budget. This was made possible through a reform, passed in the shape of an amendment in the National Assembly Rules allowing Standing Committees' to review Public Sector Development Programme (PSDP) budget of each Ministry/Division ahead of its inclusion in the Annual Budget.

Public Accounts Committee

The Public Accounts Committee is to satisfy that the monies shown in the accounts as having been disbursed were legally available to the service or purpose to which they had been applied or charged. The PAC conducts supervision in consonance with the functions enumerated in Rule 203 of National Assembly of Pakistan's Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business, 2007.

The Current PAC is focusing primarily on clearing the backlog of Audit Paras for previous years. The PAC took the Audit Reports and appropriation accounts of

the Federal Government for two years i.e., 2004-2005 and 2006-2007 and held continual meetings to complete the examination of the Auditor General's Reports and appropriation accounts. The Committee was also saddled to look into 3 years implementation status of the erstwhile directives. Plethora of important issues of public and National importance came up during the proceedings and after thorough discussion was set at rest.

The 14th PAC has constituted 4 Sub-Committees to look into Audit Paras of previous years so that the backlog of Audit Paras is cleared soon. At present, the 14th PAC has discussed 336 Audit Paras/Grants and has prepared 3 Reports to be presented to the National Assembly.

The 14th National Assembly became the second consecutive House in which Leader of the Opposition in the National Assembly, Syed Khurshid Shah, MNA, PPPP, was elected as the Chairman of the Public Accounts Committee (PAC).¹¹

Legislation

Government Bills

The 1st Parliamentary Year of the 14th National Assembly saw the introduction 22 Government Bills. Of these, the Assembly has passed 11 Government Bills in the 1st Parliamentary Year. This also includes the Federal Budget for the year 2013-2014.

It is interesting to note that 3 of the Bills passed by the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan during its 1st Parliamentary Year pertained to cracking down effectively on the terrorist activities across the country. The 3 Bills passed by the Assembly were the Protection of Pakistan Act, 2014, Anti-terrorism (Amendment) Act, 2014, Anti-terrorism (Second Amendment) Act, 2014. These Bills aimed at addressing shortcomings on counter-terrorism financing and amending the existing legal provisions on dealing with terrorism to ensure a swifter dispensation of justice. It is important to note that dealing with terrorism had been one of the major agendas of the current Government, which was also reflected in the legislative activity initiated by the Treasury benches.

Other Bills passed by the National Assembly dealt with structural and employment re-adjustment in various

10. Please see details at: PILDAT Background Paper: Parliamentary Budget Reforms in Pakistan:

http://www.pildat.org/Publications/publication/budget/ParliamentaryBudgetReformsinPakistan_Feb2013.pdf

11. Please see details at: Khursheed Shah elected as PAC Chairman, The Nation, December 11 2013: <http://www.nation.com.pk/islamabad/11-Dec-2013/khurshid-shah-elected-as-pac-chairman>

State Institutions. For example, the Federal Public Service Commission (Amendment) Act, 2014 amended the existing Federal Public Service Ordinance, 1977 to ensure that members of the Commission, after the completion of their tenure, can continue Government service in some other State Institution, which the existing law previously prohibited.¹²

Private Members' Bills

The 1st Parliamentary Year of the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan saw the introduction of 43 Private Members' Bills. However, none of these were

passed by the National Assembly.

Ordinances

A total of 12 Ordinances were laid in 14th National Assembly of Pakistan during its 1st Parliamentary Year which marked a somewhat weak legislative performance if compared with only 11 Bills passed. Perhaps the most significant Ordinance laid down during the 1st Parliamentary Year was the Protection of Pakistan Ordinance, 2013 and a subsequent Amendment. Other significant Ordinances related to amendments in the Anti-terrorism laws, amendments in the Sales Tax regime, amendments in the Criminal Law of Pakistan, etc.

Figure 5: Presentation of Bills in the National Assembly

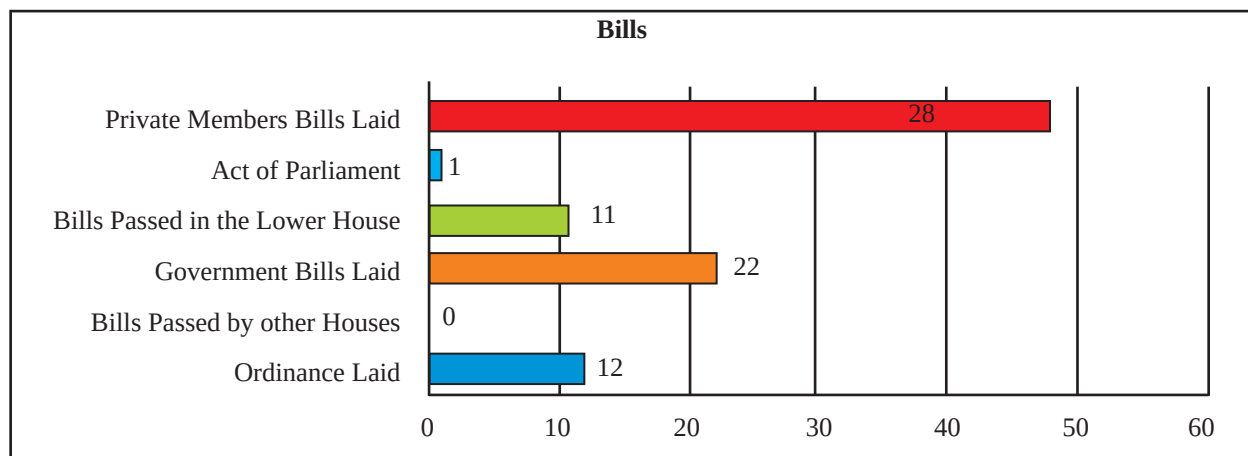
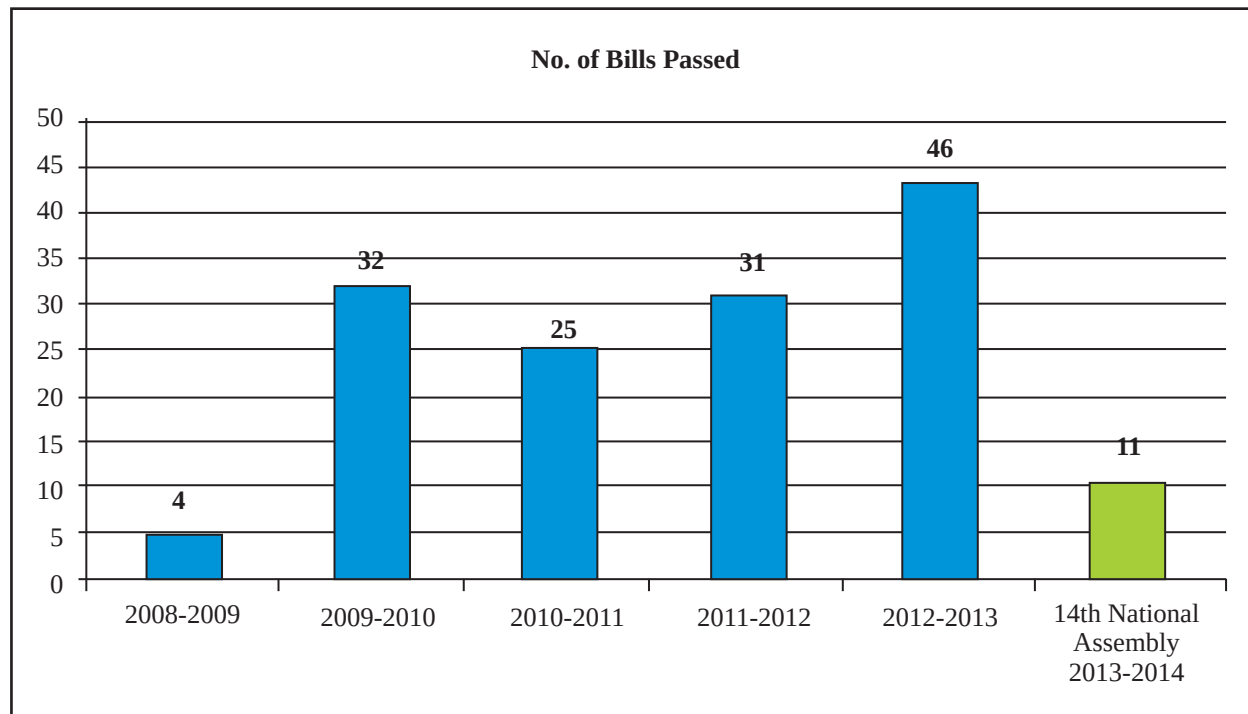


Table 3: Bills Passed by the 14th National Assembly: 1st Parliamentary Year

No.	Date	Title
1.	April 7, 2014	The Protection of Pakistan Act, 2014
2.	April 7, 2014	The Service Tribunals (Amendment) Act, 2014
3.	March 31, 2014	The Surveying and Mapping Act, 2014
4.	March 7, 2014	Federal Public Service Commission (Amendment) Act, 2014
5.	March 5, 2014	Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan (Amendment) Act, 2014
6.	February 27, 2014	National Judicial (Policy Making) Committee (Amendment) Act, 2014
7.	February 24, 2014	The Legal Practitioners and Bar Councils (Amendment) Act, 2013
8.	February 6, 2014	Anti-terrorism (Second Amendment) Act, 2014
9.	February 6, 2014	Anti-terrorism (Amendment) Act, 2014
10.	February 2, 2014	Federal Court (Repeal) Act, 2014
11.	June 27, 2013	The Finance Bill, 2013

12. Please see details at: Federal Public Service Commission (Amendment) Act, 2014: <http://www.na.gov.pk/en/bills.php?status=pass>

Figure 6: No. of Bills Passed



Resolutions

The Assembly passed 56 Resolutions in its 1st Parliamentary Year which emphasized important issues of public importance, including security situation, foreign policy, law and order, energy, load shedding and the Polio crisis. The Opposition was more active in sponsoring agenda on good governance.

Legislators from the Jamaat e Islaami (JI) and Muttahida Quami Movement (MQM) came up with two separate Resolutions calling upon the Federal Government to take immediate steps to control inflation. The MQM moved another Resolution urging the Government to take steps to provide inexpensive and expeditious justice to the people. However, the Assembly did not take up any of these Resolutions.

Calling Attention Notices

According to the National Assembly's Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business, "a member may with the previous permission of the Chair call the attention of a Minister to any matter of urgent public importance and the Minister may make a brief statement or ask for time to make a statement during the

same or next sitting, provided that no member shall give more than two such notices for any one sitting".¹³

In light of this provision, the Assembly Secretariat received 753 Calling Attention Notices. Of these, the House took up 143 and discussed 118. There were 408 Motions under Rule 259 of which 9 were discussed in the Assembly. In all, 65 Questions of Privilege were raised of which 23 were held in order and referred to the Committee concerned.

Adjournment Motions

Members may often request the Speaker to adjourn the House to consider a matter of public importance. By moving the Adjournment Motion, they try to impress upon the Presiding Officer that their concern regarding a particular issue justifies that the National Assembly adjourns or stops its normal working and considers the matter, which is being raised.

In order to consider a matter of public importance, the 14th National Assembly deliberated on 1 Adjournment Motion throughout the 1st Parliamentary Year. In addition, 40 Adjournment Motions were converted into

13. Please see details at: Rules of Procedure & Conduct of Business in National Assembly <http://www.na.gov.pk/en/downloads.php>

Figure 7: Adjournment Motions

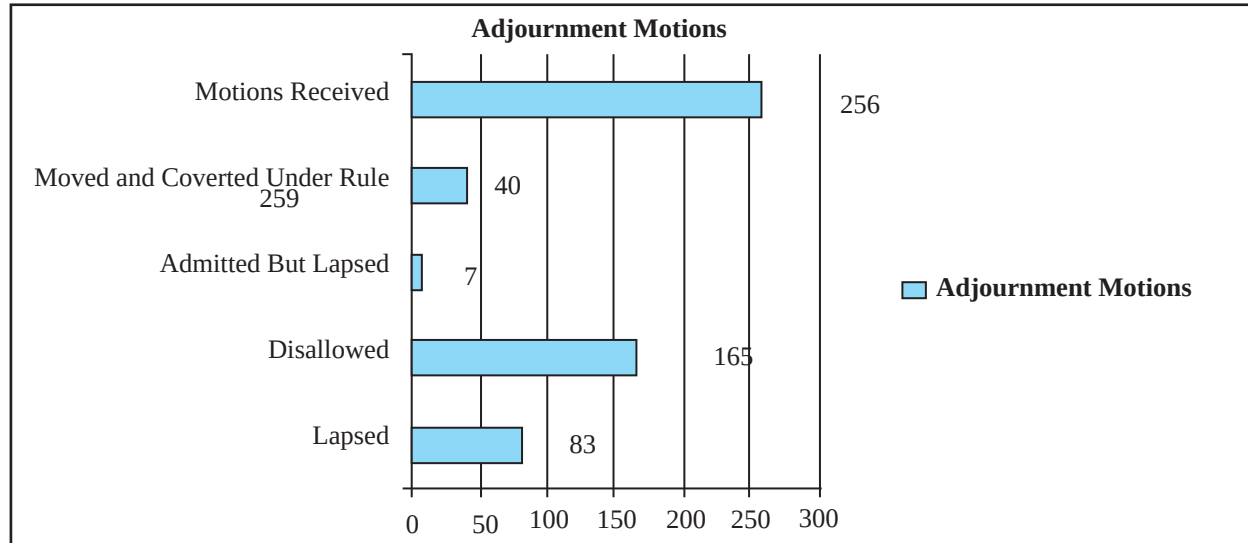
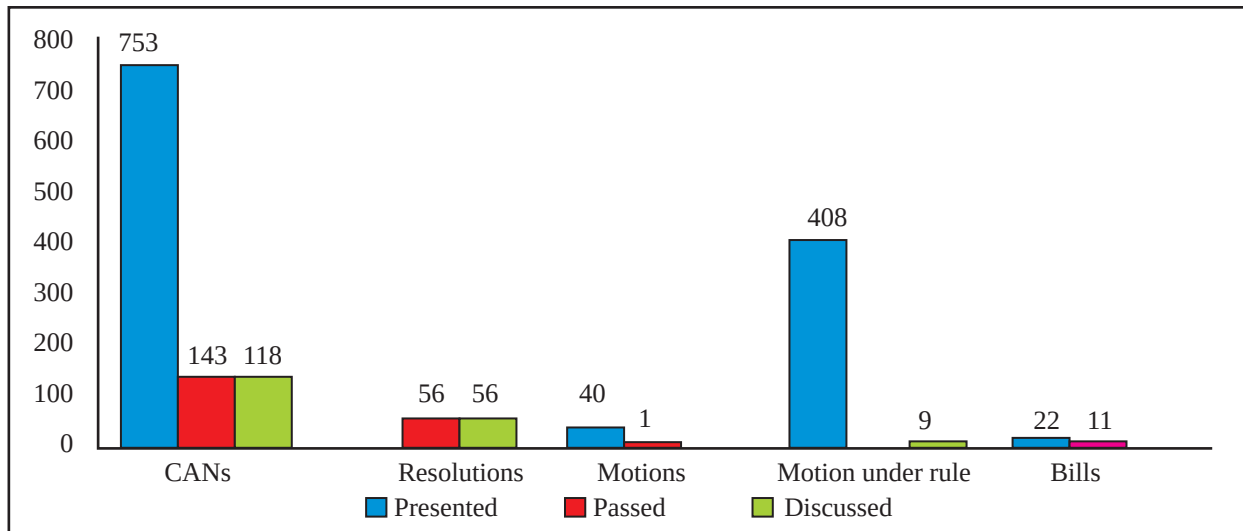


Figure 8: Bills, Calling Attention Notices, Resolutions, and Motions



Motions under Rule 259 and discussed in the Assembly. 4 motions on governance issues were moved under Rule 259 in the first 100 days of the National Assembly.¹⁴ However, only 1 motion sponsored by a PML-N legislator about the excessive spending of Pakistani foreign missions was taken up and debated.

Questions

The members of the 14th National Assembly took an ardent interest in the Question Hour and submitted 8660 Starred and Unstarred Questions. Of these, 2703 were answered. This shows a 12% increase in the number of answered questions in comparison to previous year of the 13th National Assembly.

14. Please see details at: PILDAT report: Assessment of the Quality of Democracy in the First 100 Days of the National and Provincial Governments, June 6 – September 13, 2013 http://www.pildat.org/publications/publication/SDR/AssessmentoftheQualityofDemocracyinFirst100daysofNationalandProvincialGovernments_Sep2013.pdf

Figure 9: Status of Questions

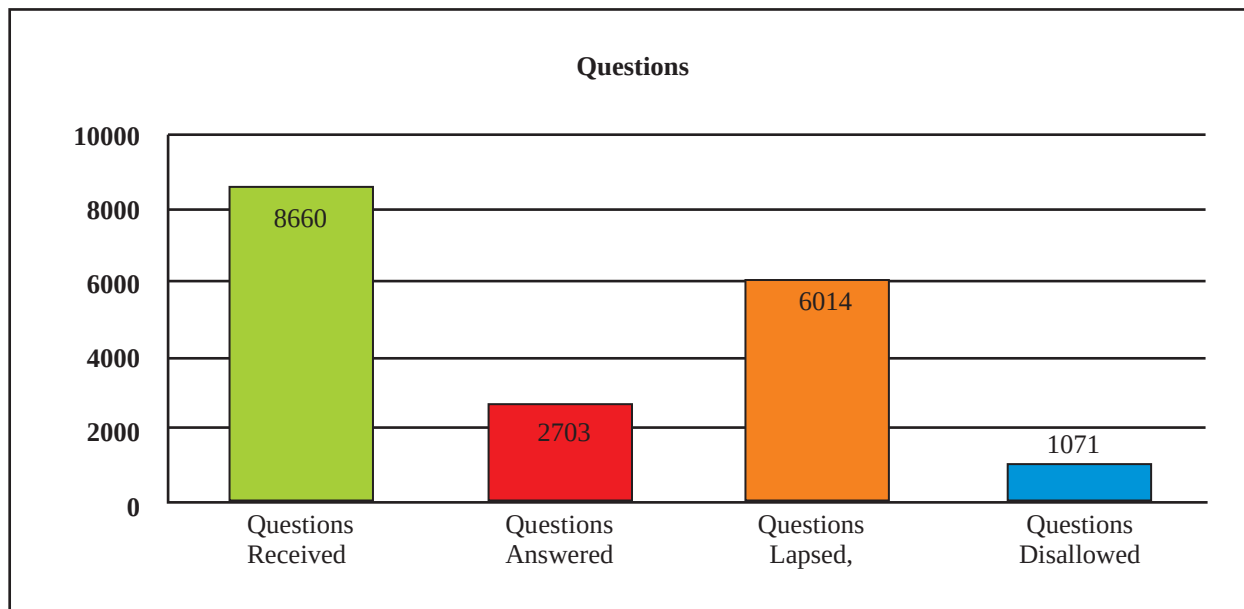
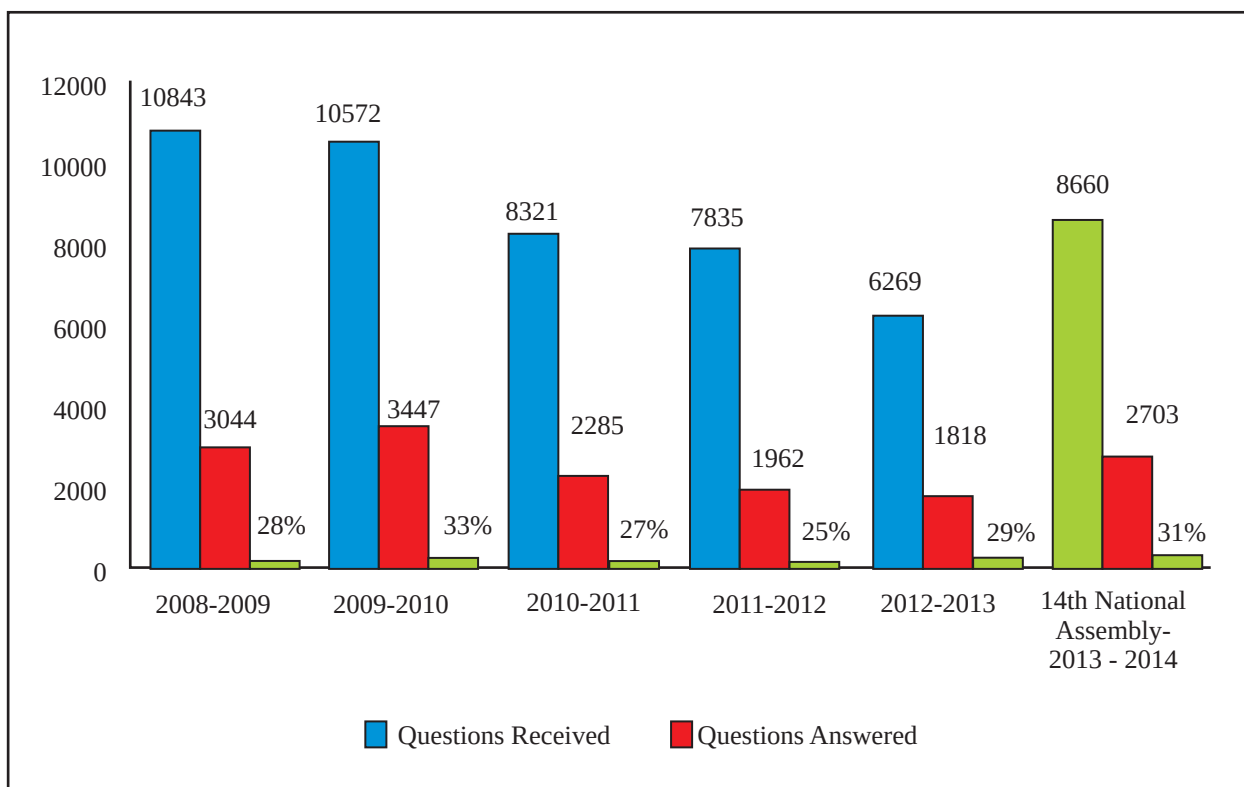


Figure 10: Comparison of Questions Received and Answered



Attendance in the National Assembly

The attendance of members continues to be problematic over the 1st Parliamentary Year of the 14th National Assembly. A lack of quorum was observed 21 times while the Prime Minister of Pakistan Mr. Muhammad Nawaz Sharif only appeared 7 times to participate in National Assembly proceedings. This constitutes to be a presence of 2% only by the Prime Minister in the 1st Parliamentary Year of the current Assembly.

On the other hand, Pakistan Tehreek e Insaaf (PTI) Chairman Mr. Imran Khan, MNA attended the National Assembly proceedings for 11 days only in the 1st Parliamentary Year. The appearance percentage reflects that Mr. Imran Khan, MNA, PTI participated once in every sitting. Maulana Fazlur Rahman, MNA, JUI-F is not much different from the aforementioned leaders, as he also attended the proceeding only on 15 days out of the total sittings of the Assembly. Mr. Pervaiz Elahi, MNA, PML also became part of the proceedings only for 11 days. Interestingly, Eng Usman Khan Taraki, MNA, AJIP and Sardar Kamal Khan Bangulzai, MNA, NP attended the proceeding of the Assembly for only two days in the whole Parliamentary Year. Mr. Mehmood Khan Achakzai, MNA, PMAP, remained at the top among other Parliamentary Leaders with 60 days attendance during the 1st Parliamentary Year of the current Assembly. Sahibzada Tariq Ullah, MNA, JI remained second among other parliamentary leaders with 59 days of attendance. Available figures further show that Mr. Aftab Ahmed Khan Sherpao, MNA, QWP-S attended the National Assembly sessions for 46 days, Sheikh Rashid, MNA, AML for 42 days, Pir Saddar-ud-Din Rashidi, MNA, PML-F, 30 days, and Mr. Iftikhar ud Din, MNA, APML, for 40 days.¹⁵

Citizens, however, have to strain to get the above information as the National Assembly continues to deny them the basic right of providing record of attendance of each Member of the National Assembly. PILDAT, which has been struggling for greater transparency in Parliament, has repeatedly asked the National Assembly to provide for record of attendance of individual members publicly. PILDAT finally asked for the National Assembly members' attendance record invoking the Freedom of Information Ordinance, 2002. After the request was declined by the National Assembly Secretariat, PILDAT appealed to the Wafaqi Mohtasib (Federal Ombudsman) which, after holding proceedings for the past many months, upheld

PILDAT's point of view and "recommended" (that's all the ombudsman can do) to the National Assembly in its "Findings and Recommendations" of 30th September 2013 to provide the requested attendance records. The National Assembly may choose to file an appeal against this verdict with the President of Pakistan where such appeals are known to sit for years. But one should hope that better sense will prevail and the National Assembly Secretariat, under the new Honourable Speaker, will turn a new leaf and make the MNAs' attendance record public. No positive developments, however, have been made in this regard during the first year. It is important to point out here that daily attendance records of Indian Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha are regularly displayed on their respective websites and so is the practice in most other Parliaments around the world.

Foreign Visits & Incoming Guests/Delegations

The National Assembly has taken a number of steps for cementing relations with Parliaments of other countries. Parliamentary friendship groups have been established on the reciprocity basis with 90 Parliaments and Parliamentary Exchange Programme¹⁶ has been revitalized.

In its first year, the 14th National Assembly formed 88 Friendship Groups with respective Parliaments of the other countries. These Groups enabled the honourable members to pursue the ideals of parliamentary diplomacy and help promote the soft image of the country.

Furthermore, Mr. Ban Ki Moon, Secretary General of the United Nations, Foreign Minister of Germany, Minister of Trade of Yemen, Members of the EU Parliament, MPs from Argentina, Afghanistan, India, the Maldives, Portugal, the UK and other countries also visited the National Assembly of Pakistan.

The Honourable Speaker also headed Parliamentary Delegations on bilateral visits to Sri Lanka, the UAE, Russia, Tajikistan and Saudi Arabia and furthermore also represented Pakistan at the Inter Parliamentary Union's 129th and 130th Assemblies in Geneva and along with attending the 7th SAARC Speakers Conference in Male, the Maldives.

Year 2013-2014 witnessed a discernible increase in the in-coming Parliamentary Delegations to Pakistan. 8 delegations, led by the respective Speakers of the friendly Parliaments visited within the year. These include:

15. Please see details at: Top NA Absentees, The Nation, May 21, 2014: <http://www.nation.com.pk/E-Paper/Lahore/2014-05-21/page-1/detail-5>

16. Please see details at: National Assembly Performance Report: http://www.na.gov.pk/uploads/1402379841_443.pdf

1. The Vice Chairperson of the People's Congress of China
2. The Chairman of the Saudi Majlis-e-Shoura
3. Lord Speaker of the House of Lords, Great Britain
4. President of the German Bundestag
5. Speaker of Iraq' Council of Representatives
6. Speaker of Bahrain's House of Representatives
7. Speaker of the Swedish Riksdag and
8. Speaker of the Republic of Korea (on the invitation of Senate of Pakistan).

Furthermore, 72 Members, belonging to all Parliamentary parties represented in the Assembly, were sent on bilateral visits, conferences, Parliamentary Seminars and workshops abroad.

Debates & Policy Inputs

The 14th National Assembly debated the clashes along the Line of Control (LoC) during the first sitting of its fourth session. Under Rule 288 of the National Assembly's Rules of Procedure, the agenda on the orders of the day was suspended to debate LoC violations. Later, the Assembly unanimously adopted a Supplementary Resolution to condemn the aggression of the Indian military forces across the Line of Control. The Resolution tabled by Federal Minister for Science and Technology also condemned the attack on Pakistan High Commission and the demonstration outside PIA office in New Delhi, preventing the Friendship Bus from proceeding to Pakistan.

The resolutions called for the Government to ensure security in Islamabad Capital Territory and to control the use of fake SIMs, rising prices of petroleum and load shedding. PTI, MQM and PPP lawmakers moved the Resolutions. A Resolution regarding manufacturing, import and sale of toy weapons was left unaddressed.

1st National Internal Security Policy of Pakistan

After nearly 9 months of the formation of Prime Minister Muhammad Nawaz Sharif's Government, the first National Internal Security Policy of Pakistan was presented in the National Assembly of Pakistan on February 26, 2014. Despite the delay, it was not only commendable that a policy was unveiled, but also that the Government, after the nod of the Federal Cabinet, has presented its key features to the National Assembly.

The NISP is based on two principles: i.e., of mutual inclusiveness and integration of all national security

efforts and includes three elements:

1. Dialogue with all stakeholders
2. Isolation of terrorists from their support systems
3. Deterrence enhancement by capacity building of the security apparatus to neutralise threats to internal security of Pakistan.

17th Speakers' Conference

The 17th Speakers' Conference¹⁷ was inaugurated at the Parliament House by the Honourable Sardar Ayaz Sadiq, Speaker of the National Assembly in Islamabad on April 17, 2014. In attendance were the Speakers of all four Provincial Assemblies as the Conference aimed at providing a platform to the Custodians of the House to discuss matters pertaining to the legislatures and to strengthen democratic values in the country.

Various matters were discussed by the 5 Speakers and the accompanying Secretaries which included the need to bring uniformity in the Service Rules of all the legislatures regarding the status of Secretariat employees and their pay-scales. For this purpose, a Committee headed by the Senate Secretary was formed to look into the matter immediately. The Conference also emphasized the need to institutionalize the 'Zero Hour' so that Points of Order could be raised by the legislators as per the rules only.¹⁸ In order to better inform the Parliamentarians regarding the legislative nuances, the Speakers resolved to strengthen the capacity of the Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services (PIPS). There was consensus on enhancing the research and automation facilities in all legislatures. The Conference decided to form a Technical Committee comprising the IT managers of all the legislatures, headed by the Director General IT of the National Assembly with the task to propose an integration plan for IT and online library facilities.

Greater emphasis was laid on the co-ordination between all the legislatures via inter-parliamentary delegation to enhance inter-provincial harmony and relations.

18. Please see details at: 17th Speaker's Conference – National Assembly of Pakistan: <http://www.na.gov.pk/uploads/17th-Speakers-Conf/bulletins%20vol--2.pdf>

PART-III

Strategic Analysis, Major
Challenges and Required
Reforms to Strengthen the
National Assembly of Pakistan

Strategic Analysis

Members of 14th National Assembly took oath on June 1, 2013. In his inaugural speech, the Prime Minister identified 8 themes that the Government wanted to focus on during its tenure:

1. Economic Development
2. Democracy and Political Development
3. Improved Foreign Relations
4. Good Governance
5. Strengthening the Federation
6. Peace Building and Conflict Resolution
7. Energy Sector Reforms
8. Protection of Human Rights

The issues of terrorism and extremism across the country remained the highlight of the Prime Minister's inaugural speech. He touched on the topic 6 times.

The 14th National Assembly's legislative activity during the 1st Parliamentary Year was reflective of Government's priority of dealing with terrorism with 4 Ordinances laid dealing with beefing up the anti-terrorist laws along with the passage of Bills such as the Protection of Pakistan Act, 2013. The Bill mainly authorizes Civil and Military Law Enforcement Agencies (LEAs) to fire upon, arrest without warrant or enter and search without warrant any premises on forming a 'reasonable apprehension' against any person, preventive detention of up to 90 days. The Bill appears to have been prepared to protect the Civil and Military LEAs.

As has been the practice over the years, on major issues facing the country, instead of being the main repository of policy review and advice, the national legislature largely remained outside the policy loop and vital issues were seldom presented or seriously discussed in

this forum. Energy, for instance, which was cited as one of the most pressing problems of Pakistan by the people.¹⁹ was not debated by the Government in the House. While the PML-N Government unveiled a National Energy Policy 2013-2018,²⁰ the policy was not presented by the Prime Minister to the House for discussion.

The raging conflict that has spilt on the streets of Lahore and Islamabad in August 2014 once again indicates that the National Assembly of Pakistan has failed to become the legitimate forum for resolution of political and national conflicts. The Assembly, by virtue of an apparent lack of importance both by the Government and the Opposition, remained unsuccessful in providing workable recommendations on resolving Pakistan's key issues.

On what appears now to be a "pressing" issue of required electoral reforms in Pakistan, neither the Parliamentary leadership of the PTI, which repeatedly, throughout the 1st Parliamentary Year, accused the PML-N of indulging in electoral malpractices, cared to present a comprehensive set of required electoral reforms to the Assembly, nor the Government used the legitimate forum of the National Assembly throughout the first year to systematically address the critical issue. An analysis of Private Members Bills reveals that during the 1st year, the PTI merely resorted to asking for an amendment to the Representation of the People's Act, 1976 by calling for the inclusion of Returning Officer's in the list of respondents in a petition regarding electoral malpractices and the appointment of serving judges of the High Court as arbiters in the Election Tribunals.²¹ On the other hand, the Government, which first offered to form a Parliamentary Committee on Electoral Reforms in August 2013,²² did not follow through on its promise

19. Please find details at: IRI Survey: <http://tribune.com.pk/story/628369/iri-survey-for-most-pakistanis-power-crisis-is-the-real-problem/>

20. Please see details at: Pakistan's new energy policy, The Express Tribune, August 6, 2013. <http://tribune.com.pk/story/587273/pakistans-new-energy-policy/>

21. Please see details at: The Representation of the People (Amendment) Act, 2014. Available for download from the 'Private Members' Bills Laid' section of the National Assembly website; can be accessed at http://www.na.gov.pk/uploads/documents/1399367436_709.pdf

22. On August 15, 2013, during a sitting of the National Assembly, the Federal Interior Minister Chaudhary Nisar Ali Khan, MNA, responding to the concerns of Pakistan Tehrik-e-Insaf (PTI) presented in a Calling Attention Notice regarding rigging in the May 11, 2013 General Election, said that a Special Committee of the House should be constituted to investigate the matter in its entirety and furnish proposals for electoral reforms. The Interior Minister said that the Committee should be given a timeframe of one month to complete its findings and proposals and should be fully authorized to summon the former Caretaker Prime Minister and Caretaker Chief Ministers in order to expose the truth to the public. He said that those involved in rigging should be de-seated. He also said that the Government and Opposition should point out 20 constituencies each to examine whether any rigging was done there. On the occasion, the Leader of the Opposition Syed Khurshid Ahmad Shah, MNA, welcomed the Government's decision to form a Committee on Election rigging and Electoral Reforms. PTI leader Shah Mehmood Qureshi, MNA said the issue was raised by his party chief Imran Khan and his party had no objection on the formation of a committee. Upon this, the Deputy Speaker Mr. Murtaza Javed Abbasi, MNA, asked the heads of the parties to nominate their members for a meeting after three days on the terms of reference of the committee. However, after this announcement, the formation of the Committee hit a snag and the nomination of the members by the political parties was delayed beyond the set deadline. On October 10, 2013, the Minister for Science and Technology, Mr. Zahid Hamid, MNA, while chairing the Inter-Provincial Roundtable on Required Electoral Reforms by PILDAT said that a Parliamentary Committee on Electoral Reforms is to be constituted soon. Eventually, on June 11, 2014, after the completion of the 1st Parliamentary Year of the 14th National Assembly, the Prime Minister wrote to the National Assembly Speaker, asking him to constitute a Special Parliamentary Committee comprising members of the two Houses of Parliament to take up the issue of electoral reforms. It was only on July 26, 2014, nearly a year after the idea of the Committee was floated by the Government, that the Speaker National Assembly constituted a 33-member Parliamentary Committee on Electoral Reforms.

until after the completion of the 1st year of the 14th National Assembly and nearly a year after it first made such a promise.

In a welcome development, however, on June 24, 2013, Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif made a policy announcement at the floor of the House regarding his Government's decision to proceed with the High Treason case against the former Chief of Army Staff / President General (Retired) Pervez Musharraf. Opposition leaders from the PPP and the PTI extended their support to the Prime Minister. The treason trial, which ended up indicting Gen. (Retd.) Musharraf, has been the first of its kind in Pakistan relating to the imposition of emergency rule by Gen. (Retd.) Musharraf on November 3, 2007.

Furthermore, Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif also announced on January 29, 2014 on the floor of the Assembly that his Government would pursue peace talks with Taliban militants naming a four-member committee to facilitate the talks. Prime Minister said that he would personally supervise the performance of the Committee, adding that he was sincerely trying to restore peace in the country and expressed his hope that the other side would reciprocate in a similar manner.

Despite repeated demands, the Assembly also failed to institute a specific Question Hour for the Prime Minister while this is a Parliamentary tradition around the World.

In a welcome development, the Honourable Speaker National Assembly announced the introduction of a transparent and merit-based hiring process in the National Assembly Secretariat through the Federal Public Service Commission (FPSC). The decision, according to the Honourable Speaker, was made to re-structure the National Assembly Secretariat driven by the three-pronged objective of merit, task-identification and the economy. This has been a long-standing reform proposal to route the recruitment in all Parliamentary Secretariat through the FPSC. This decision, announced by the Honourable Speaker, would lead to transparent and merit based recruitment whereby the best applicants would secure jobs in the National Assembly. PILDAT has recommended that the much-needed initiative should also be made part of the Recruitment Rules of the National Assembly of Pakistan to ensure that the process is made permanent and is also followed by subsequent Assemblies. There is a need that the change in recruitment rules is adopted by all legislatures across Pakistan. In addition,

promotions of the Assembly Staff should also be made subject to their successful completion of courses at the National School of Public Policy in order to better train and increase the performance of the staff. It is worth noting that the Senate of Pakistan is already sending officers on training in the institutions to enhance the management and decision making capacity of the parliamentary staff at both the middle and senior levels.

In a welcome development, the 14th National Assembly, upon the conclusion of the first year of its term, presented its own performance report highlighting various aspects of its working while enlisting various reforms that have been underway upon the initiative of the new legislative leadership.²³

The publication of this report by the National Assembly is indeed a milestone towards greater transparency and public access.

The report identifies various reforms that have been undertaken during the first year. These include the development of a **Strategic Plan 2013-2018** putting forward required reforms to make the Assembly more effective, efficient, respected and well informed; setting up of a **Project Management Unit** in July 2013 to monitor, evaluate and streamline donor activities under a central coordination mechanism and the introduction of **Human Resource reforms** to enhance staff capability management. The report highlights that efforts to create a Legislative Council in the Parliament under the Strategic Plan 2013-2018 are underway to improve the in-house capabilities of drafting legislation. The report also adds that in order to develop Human Resource with regards to the Legislative Drafting Unit, the Honourable Speaker has invited 26 universities and education institutes to offer courses of parliamentary studies. The Assembly is also considering ICT Reforms to move towards a greater paper-less Parliament and the introduction of Management Information System.

Perhaps the most important in the reform proposals identified has been **Reforming PIPS**. The report states that the Pakistan Institute of Parliamentary Services (PIPS) was revitalized in order to make maximum use of this valuable facility. In this regard, a new Board was constituted which brought vibrancy by holding 6 meetings during this year and developing a KPI and activity based annual business and work plan.

The Assembly missed the deadline to form Standing Committees by more than a month and a half in

23. Please see details at: Performance of 14th National Assembly: www.na.gov.pk/uploads/1402379841_443.pdf

violation of Rule 200 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business of the National Assembly of Pakistan. The formation of 29 Standing Committees of the National Assembly was approved in the fourth session on August 21, 2013 exceeding the limit of 30 days. One commendable development has been the continuation of the tradition of appointment of Chairpersons of the Standing Committees in proportion of the parties' representation in the National Assembly. This has resulted in 15 Chairpersons belonging to the ruling PML-N, 4 to the PPPP, 3 to the PTI, 3 to the PML, 2 to the MQM and 1 to the PMAP and the JUI-F each. Furthermore, in keeping with the commendable tradition set during the 13th National Assembly of Pakistan, the Leader of the Opposition, Syed Khursheed Shah, MNA, PPPP, was elected as the Chairperson of the all-important Public Accounts Committee (PAC).

Similarly, for the first time in Pakistan, after considerable bipartisan reform²⁴ efforts by PILDAT over the years, Standing Committees in the National Assembly began to scrutinize ministerial budget proposals ahead of their inclusion to the Federal Budget. This was made possible through a reform, passed in the shape of an amendment in the National Assembly Rules allowing Standing Committees' to review Public Sector Development Programme (PSDP) budget of each Ministry/Division ahead of its inclusion in the Annual Budget.

Overall, there were no significant reforms²⁵ introduced in the **Budget** process that lasted for only 17 working days. Members merely went through the motions of the Budget to place their approval on it. MNA participation saw a 20% decline in the 2013-2014 Budget Session in comparison to the previous (13th National Assembly) of Pakistan where, on average, 169 Members participated in each of the 5 Budget sessions. A 12.2% increase in the time spent debating the Budget compared to the average time spent in all of the Budget sessions of the previous Assembly was also observed.

Major challenges faced by the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan during its 1st Parliamentary Year

- i. Lack of punctuality: Almost every sitting during

the first seven sessions started late by an average of 1.5 hours. This results in wastage of tens of thousands of working hours of legislators, officials of various departments engaged with Assembly business, media and civil society

- ii. Question Hour too short to accommodate queries from a 342-strong House
- iii. Delay in constitution of Standing Committees
- iv. Financial constraints hampering fully functioning of Standing Committees as these cannot engage experts for their input
- v. Time too short to scrutinize/debate Budget
- vi. Poor support from Assembly Secretariat in research and drafting of laws
- vii. Shortage of qualified support staff

24. Please see details at: PILDAT Background Paper: Parliamentary Budget Reforms in Pakistan:

http://www.pildat.org/Publications/publication/budget/ParliamentaryBudgetReformsinPakistan_Feb2013.pdf

25. Please see details at: PILDAT report: Assessment of the Quality of Democracy in the First 100 Days of the National and Provincial Governments, June 6 – September 13, 2013:

http://www.pildat.org/publications/publication/SDR/AssessmentoftheQualityofDemocracyinFirst100daysofNationalandProvincialGovernments_Sep2013.pdf

Proposed Reforms to Strengthen the National Assembly of Pakistan

While democratic and legislative reforms continue even in developed democracies, the case for the required reform is considered to be much stronger in Pakistan owing to almost regular disruption of democracy throughout the past 6 decades. That Pakistan's elected Legislatures should be truly representative of the people of Pakistan, be accessible to the public, reflect public aspirations in legislation and safeguard public's interests through overseeing the elected Government are some of the key roles and responsibilities of the Parliament.

In order to effectively carry out the Constitutional responsibilities of *Representation*, *Legislation* and *Oversight*, certain key reforms are needed in the National Assembly of Pakistan. Now that the new Assembly is in place, this is considered the most opportune time to highlight and work for institution of required reforms so as to improve the performance of the National Assembly of Pakistan.

PILDAT has had the honour of assisting the National Assembly of Pakistan and elected legislators since 2002. Throughout its modest contributions and assistance to the Assembly, PILDAT has been fortunate in receiving guidance from the Assembly leadership and wide variety of its multi-party representation over the years.

1. Increase "Actual" Working Days of Assembly

The original 1973 constitution provided that the National Assembly should meet for a minimum of 160 days in a year. This number was later revised downward and according to Article 54 (2) of the Constitution of Pakistan, the National Assembly is required to meet for a minimum of 130 days in a year. However, a break of two days during an on-going session is also counted while computing the number of days in the context of this constitutional requirement.

If the two-days break is disregarded, the combined average of 'actual' working days of the National Assembly has been 103 days for the 13th National Assembly (2008-2013) and 77 working days for the 12th National Assembly (2002-2007).

The average working hours per day for the five years of 13th National Assembly comes out to be around 2 hours and 06 minutes per day compared

to the average of a little over 3 hours of the 12th National Assembly.

While the outgoing 13th National Assembly registered a welcome increase of 31% in the number of days it met, it had recorded a decrease in average working hours per day.

It is recommended that both the 'actual' working days and working hours of the National Assembly be increased. In all established democracies, legislatures remain in session all the year round except for well-defined breaks. That is how the Parliament ensures its supremacy. A Parliament can not be taken seriously in absentia. Even if the working days can not be increased at this stage, the number of working hours per day should be increased to 6 hours per day on the average.

2. Prime Minister's Presence in the House & PM Question Time

In keeping with global Parliamentary norms and traditions, the Honourable Prime Minister should himself answer questions at least once a week and at least 30 minutes be allocated for this purpose in each week in line with the practice in most of the parliamentary democracies.

The Honourable Speaker is requested to encourage the new Prime Minister to make it a habit to regularly attend the Assembly when it is in session. The Prime Minister should also use the floor of the Assembly for making all important statements or announcements.

The Honourable Prime Minister should be commended for first taking the house into confidence regarding his Government's decision to proceed with the High Treason case against the former Chief of Army Staff / President General (Retired) Pervez Musharraf. This act was widely appreciated both inside and outside the parliament. This tradition should be continued.

The Speaker should also encourage his colleagues to amend the Assembly Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business to provide for a weekly Question Period (say 30 minutes) for the Prime Minister. Prime Minister's greater involvement in the proceedings of the Assembly will go a long way in strengthening the institution and establishing its supremacy. Since such a question time is widely telecasted, this direct engagement will provide an additional and valuable channel of communication with the people at large and

people will get a much-needed feeling that their government and head of the government are answerable to them.

It is strongly recommended that the Honourable Prime Minister should regularly attend the National Assembly sittings in line with the traditions of the Parliamentary form of government.

3. Adherence to Parliamentary Calendar

Members have repeatedly demanded that the National Assembly of Pakistan should develop a Parliamentary calendar at the start of the fresh term as well as at the start of each Parliamentary year. Members also demand that once a calendar is prepared, it should also be adhered to completely. It will greatly help the members of the Assembly, civil society which wants to engage with the Assembly, and all those who are involved or should be involved in the working of the Assembly if a calendar of sessions of the Assembly is prepared and made public before the beginning of the Parliamentary year. This calendar will be meaningful if, except for extra-ordinary exceptions, it is strictly followed too.

4. Punctuality & Decorum

The National Assembly sittings have suffered delays sometime by hours. Its sittings seldom started in time.

The Honourable Speaker may start a glorious tradition to be in the House himself on the dot at the appointed time and start proceedings. This will set the tone of the 14th assembly and will serve as a great example to the society at large.

Sometime there is an air of casualness among the honourable members during the proceedings of the house. Members are sometimes seen engaged in prolonged greetings and conversations right in the middle of the Assembly proceedings. The former Prime Ministers had developed a routine of holding meetings with their party members, receiving their applications and affixing their comments on them right during the Assembly proceedings while sitting in the House and members took their turns in sittings next to them to present their cases. This is a clear disrespect of the House and the Speaker should not allow this to happen.

The visuals of such happenings when aired on TV channels do not enhance the prestige of the House

or the honourable members.

5. Reforms to Strengthen the Role of Committees

The National Assembly Standing Committees related to Ministries and Divisions are vital to the work of Assemblies. They serve as powerful channels to promote transparency and accountability in a Parliamentary system of government. Committees are one of the most important mechanisms by which legislatures hold state institutions accountable, question executive policies and investigate issues of public concern. Committees, as a unit of organisation within a legislature, provide the opportunity to a group of MPs for more detailed investigation and discussions on an issue, review policy matters or review bills more closely than would be possible by the entire chamber.

Committees are referred to as “*Assemblies at work*” while the plenary is called “*Assembly at exhibition*.” Due to a variety of reasons, chief among which is lack of institutional stability and growth due to derailing of democracy, Committees in the National Assembly have not fully been able to leverage their potential and optimise their performance. As a result, the committees have not been very effective in performing their constitutional responsibility of overseeing the elected Government and holding the executive to account on behalf of the people.

The following proposals are meant to strengthen the committees in the National Assembly:

i. Composition of the Standing Committees be based on Members' interest / aptitude and experience

In order to improve the output and effectiveness of the committees, the need for their composition on the basis of members' interest, aptitude and their past experience is stressed. Political expediency should not be allowed to dictate such decisions which result, in many cases, paralysis of the committees chaired by disinterested chairs.

ii. Dedicated Committee Suites

Around the World, legislatures and legislative structures provide for required dedicated space for committees to function. Unfortunately, in Pakistan's Parliament, very deficient facilities exist in the form of far fewer committee rooms than required to serve a house of 342 members and nearly 35 parliamentary Committees. The situation becomes more critical as the Senate

committees also use the same common facilities.

It is, therefore, recommended, that the National Assembly create space for 30 dedicated committee suites. Each suite should comprise a conference room to serve the entire strength of the committee and staff, office of the chairperson and office space of the dedicated committee staff.

iii. Staffing & Better Research Support for Committees

For effective performance of Standing Committees, it is essential that a system of subject-specialist research support is provided by the Assembly to the committee.

It is recommended that the existing staffing structures of committees be revised. Instead of providing the chairperson with PA, assistants and drivers, etc., a dedicated secretary and at least 2 research assistants well-versed with the subject of the committee be provided for an effective functioning of the committee.

The key job of executive oversight can not be carried out by committees in the absence of independent research support and staff. Researchers specializing in some key areas and general researchers assisted by interns consisting of post-graduate students or fresh graduates in relevant subjects should be arranged to assist the committees in particular and the MNAs in general.

iv. Legislation should only be processed through the concerned Standing Committees

It is observed that at times some important bills are passed in a short time after suspending the rules and by-passing the requirement of scrutiny by the concerned standing committees. It is recommended that all legislation should always be examined in-depth by the concerned standing committees before it is considered by the full House for passage.

It is also recommended that more time should be allocated for debates on legislation.

v. Time-limit of Presentation of Reports by Committees

According to the Rule 201 (3) in the National Assembly of Pakistan when the House makes a reference (bill or any other matter) to a particular Standing Committee and if the Committee does not give its report within the 'prescribed' time then the House can consider the report upon a motion.

However, if no time is prescribed for the presentation of the report then there is no limit for the Committee to present the report.

In contrast, the Rules of Procedure in the Lok Sabha in Indian Parliament state that when the time period has not been fixed for the Committee to present a report it should be presented within one month of the reference made to it.

This issue is of particular importance because there are a number of important bills that are stuck at the Committee level sometimes for years but are not brought in the House. An amendment in rules, therefore, is needed which sets the time period for a committee to return to the House with its report/deliberations.

vi. Proceedings of the committees should be made more transparent and accessible to media and people

It is proposed that unless the circumstances of a particular meeting warrant otherwise, committees proceedings, especially when it is not deliberating internally, should be open to public and media to observe and report.

vii. A Committee for public petitions should be created or the petitions aspect of the Standing Committees be made well known

Strong and active Parliaments draw their strength from a close and direct link with the people. An interesting aspect of this linkage is the Petitions Committee of the Parliament which invites, receives and processes the complaints sent by the people about any thing under the sun. Germany and India can be cited two examples of such an arrangement.

Although all standing committees in our Assembly may act as petition committees in their respective area of work, this aspect of the committees has remained dormant to date and needs to be strengthened.

The Chief Justice of Pakistan endeared himself to the people of Pakistan by inviting public complaints and then taking *suo moto* action on them. In fact, the Parliament is a more appropriate forum to receive such petitions.

6. Reforms in the Budget Process

"Power over purse strings" or the *"power of the purse"* is an incontestable democratic fundamental. This essentially means that there is

an obligation on elected representatives of the people in an Assembly to ensure that all revenue and spending measures they authorize, legally and constitutionally, are fiscally sound, match the needs and aspirations of the population with equity, and that they are being implemented appropriately and efficiently. It further symbolizes that it is “we the people” who make and implement the budget for themselves.

This crucial power of the elected representatives in the National Assembly of Pakistan, however, is compromised due to lack of availability of effective powers with members as well as with committees after the budget is presented.

A number of reforms are required in this regard:

i. Effective Operationalisation of the recent Amendment in Rules

A critical reform has been passed in the 13th (outgoing) National Assembly of Pakistan to allow committees the specific power of review of budgetary proposals by each ministry before these are submitted to the Ministry of Finance in Pakistan's specific budgetary cycle.²⁶

As per the revised rules, all Standing Committees have to receive proposals relating to their relevant ministry's Public Sector Development Program (PSDP) for the next financial year “not later than the 31st January” and the Standing Committee have to review the budgets and make recommendations “not later than the 1st March” of each year.

It is therefore recommended that Standing Committees are geared to optimally use this new power while the Secretariat and support staff of committees be directed to seek all possible expertise and resources on the subject to assist the committees. Operationalisation of this key reform in January 2014 is one of the most crucial aspects of strengthening National Assembly's control over the purse strings.

ii. Powers to Committees to Review Budget after the presentation of the Budget

Even though the executive can not spend any monies without approval of the finance bill from the Assembly, the existing budget process makes it impossible for the Assembly as the plenary to review the budget in its entirety and its ministry-wise demands for grants, policy plans and objectives. As a result, the power to pass budget is only exercised in name and the budget is passed without meaningful understanding and scrutiny.

Budget proposals of ministries and divisions can only be understood and scrutinised by their respective committees. In other Parliamentary systems, including next-door India, after the presentation of budget, demands for grants are referred to respective departmental committees which scrutinize individual ministerial demands for grants and report to the House by a fixed period after which the grants are voted on.

This is a critical reform without which the Assembly will continue to go through the motions of budget every year without justly fulfilling its constitutional responsibility of understanding budget before its passage.

It is recommended that the Rules of Procedure and the Conduct of Business in the National Assembly of Pakistan should be amended to provide a role for the Standing Committees to review ministerial demands for grants once the budget is presented and prepare reports by a specified period and table those reports in the House. The debate on budget should resume in the light of reports by the Committees.

iii. Increase in the Time to Debate/Scrutinize Budget

Despite its critical importance in the entire legislative business of the Assembly, the time allocated for budget session in the National Assembly of Pakistan remains as insufficient as the role in review of the budget. In the past decade,

26. On an amendment moved by a private member of the then-opposition belonging to the PML-N, Ms. Anusha Rehman Khan, MNA, the 13th National Assembly passed the following amendment in its rules on January 29, 2013:

“Amendment in rule 201:- That in the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly, 2007, in rule 201, after sub-rule (5), the following new sub-rule (6), shall be added, namely:-

“(6) Each Standing Committee shall scrutinize and suggest amendments, if necessary, and recommend Ministry's Public Sector Development Program (PSDP) for the next financial year before the same is sent to the Ministry of Finance for inclusion in the Federal Budget for the next financial year. Each Ministry shall submit its budgetary proposals relating to Public Sector Development Program (PSDP) for the next financial year to the relevant Standing Committee not later than the 31st January of preceding financial year and the Standing Committee shall make recommendations thereon not later than the 1st March of the preceding financial year:

Provided that where such recommendations are not made by the 1st March, the same shall be deemed to have been endorsed by the Standing Committee.”

the Assembly has maintained a grossly insufficient 14-day average on discussion and passage of the Federal Budget. This falls way short of the required time for adequate budget scrutiny and analysis by the Assembly. Since the earlier proposal is to allow committees a role to scrutinise departmental budgets, it can not be put in place unless the budget period is increased accordingly.

This has been of the key reform proposals by multi-party MNAs of the successive Assemblies. However, the elected representatives of the people have not been able to sway the hold of the bureaucracy in extending the budget period.

It is recommended that the budget session period needs to be increased from the existing average 14 days to about 45 days. This would require budget to be presented to the House in early May every year so as to conclude the budget session before June 30.

7. Office Space for Members

Currently, the Elected members are required to carry out their constitutional responsibilities of *Legislation, Representation and Oversight* without any office space and research assistant.

Despite repeated reform proposals, Pakistan's elected representatives continue to work unassisted without office space and assistance. Even though extension of Parliamentary lodges was undertaken and building of institutions like PIPS were built, the outgoing elected leadership at the helm of affairs of the 13th National Assembly failed to prioritise the critical requirements as it chose not to construct an office block for MNAs and Office Suites for Standing Committees.

It is recommended that providing adequate office space and research assistants to all MNAs, as well as office suites for all committees, should be one of the key priorities of the newly-elected leadership of the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan.

8. Increase in Question Time

Question Hour is one of the most important tools in the hands of elected representatives of the public to oversee the Government. It is the most important mechanism available in legislatures through which the executive answers the questions of the elected representatives. Since the number of members of the Assembly has

increased since 2002, the number of questions has also correspondingly increased. The proposal to increase the duration of the Question Hour may be seriously examined.

Additionally, the process through which MNAs are required to submit questions and through which the questions are chosen to appear on the Orders of the Day is a very complicated process. According to the Rules, Questions should be submitted 15 days in advance to the Secretary. The Questions are submitted manually in the Notice Office and are placed in the House on first come first served basis. The questions are submitted to the Notice Office in Parliament by a Member or, on the member's behalf a staff member on the last day of every session after it is prorogued. Questions submitted for a specific session stand lapsed if these are not selected for answer.

Many members, however, feel that the National Assembly should reform the process of submitting Question and use other more viable and quick procedures such as Email for submission of Questions.

9. Televis Question Hour

Question Hour is the most crucial part of the Assembly's proceedings through which the elected members hold the Government to account. Very useful details are shared with members in response to their questions. The Question Hour is telecast on Pakistan Television (PTV) only. The National Assembly should extend this facility to other private television channels also who should also telecast this section.

10. Greater Public Access & Transparency

From 2008-2013, for the first time in the National Assembly's history, the Assembly began its journey of greater transparency and public access by providing key information about the Assembly sittings and proceedings to the media and public through its website. The National Assembly's new website now carries the Orders of the Day (Daily Agenda of the Sittings), details of the Legislative Business and the Questions-Answers of the Question Hour. Parliamentary leadership who facilitated this greater transparency should be commended for making an important contribution to democracy.

The details provided on the website, however, needs to be further improved keeping in view the Parliamentary openness and transparency standards

in the South Asian region and worldwide.

However, for all the improvements in the 13th National Assembly on providing greater public access to Assembly's work, it remained regressive on some of the key issues of public information such as the complete record of attendance of each Member of the National Assembly, voting record of members, detailed profiles of members and other relevant details.

It is recommended that the new legislative leadership of the Assembly take the lead in providing public access and transparency on all aspects of the Assembly.

It is important to note that daily attendance of all members of Indian Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha is posted on their official website.

Models such as that of the Lok Sabha in India and House of Commons in UK may be adopted while providing greater access and transparency through website. Another model of a website "They Work for You" <http://www.theyworkforyou.com/> may also be considered by the National Assembly.

11. Encourage & Facilitate Greater coordination between the Assembly and Think-Tanks

Independent think-tanks and civil society organisations can provide useful information and data to the MNAs and standing committees which would greatly help the Assembly debates and committees performance. A mechanism should be evolved for a continuous coordination with such organizations which research on various issues of interest to the National Assembly.²⁷

27. PILDAT developed a Directory of Parliamentary Committees and relevant Civil Society/Research Organisations of Pakistan for the benefit of stakeholders. This can be accessed at: <http://www.pildat.org/CSODirectory/>

APPENDICES

Appendix- I

Comparison of the Legislative Performance of the 14th National Assembly of Pakistan

Table 4: Working Days and Hours

Working Days and Hours	2008-2009	2009-2010	2010-2011	2011-2012	2012-2013	2013-2014
Total No. of Days the House Met	132	136	140	144	144	130
Actual No. of Days the House Met	97	104	104	113	98	103
Total No. of Hours the House Met	277 hours and 15 minutes	355 hours and 20 minutes	300 hours and 35 minutes	228 hours and 06 minutes	184 hours and 34 minutes	322 Hours
No. of Hours met Per Day	2.86	3.49	2.88	2.02	1.88	3.13

Table 5: Government Bills

Parliamentary Year	2008-2009	2009-2010	2010-2011	2011-2012	2012-2013	2013-2014
Bills / Ordinances Introduced / Laid	30	90	34	-	-	22
Passed	03	29	24	28	46	11
Withdrawn	01	2	1	-	-	-
Pending	26	89	102	-	-	-

Table 6: Private Member's Bills

Parliamentary Year	2008-2009	2009-2010	2010-2011	2011-2012	2012-2013	2013-2014
Received	104	91	28	-	-	43
Introduced	39	64	17	40	45	-
Passed	01	3	1	03	11	-

Table 7: Questions

Parliamentary Year	2008-2009	2009-2010	2010-2011	2011-2012	2012-2013	2013-2014
Received	10843	10572	8321	7895	6269	8660
Admitted	-	5625	-	-	-	7589
Admitted but lapsed	2852	2370	1674	-	-	4886
Answered	3044	3447	2285	1962	1818	2703
Processed but Lapsed	2749	3308	3318	-	-	-

Table 8: Private Member's Bills Laid during the 1st Parliamentary Year of the 14th National Assembly

PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILLS LAID		
Sr. No.	Date	Title
1	Tuesday, May 6, 2014	The Representation of the People (Amendment) Act, 2014
2	Tuesday, May 6, 2014	The Constitution (Amendment) Act, 2014
3	Tuesday, May 6, 2014	The Compulsory Blood Test of the Relatives of Thalassaemia Patient Act, 2014
4	Tuesday, May 6, 2014	The Telegraph (Amendment) Act, 2014
5	Tuesday, May 6, 2014	The Suppression of Terrorist Activities (Special Courts) (Amendment) Act, 2014
6	Tuesday, May 6, 2014	The Protection against Harassment of Women at Workplace (Amendment) Act, 2014
7	Tuesday, May 6, 2014	The Child Protection System Bill, 2014
8	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	National Air Transportation Safety Board Act, 2014
9	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2014
10	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	Constitution (Twenty-Second Amendment) Act, 2014

11	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	Islamabad Rent Restriction (Amendment) Act, 2014
12	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	Acid and Burn Crime Bill, 2014
13	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	The Criminal Law (Amendment) Bill, 2014
14	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	National Database and Registration Authority (Amendment) Act, 2014
15	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	The Criminal Law (Amendment) Bill, 2014
16	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	The Representation of the People (Amendment) Bill, 2014
17	Tuesday, April 08, 2014	The Representation of the People (Amendment) Bill, 2014
18	Tuesday, March 25, 2014	The Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2014
19	Tuesday, March 25, 2014	The Disabled Persons Employment and Rehabilitation (Amendment) Act, 2014
20	Tuesday, March 25, 2014	The Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2014
21	Tuesday, March 25, 2014	The Prohibition of Corporal Punishment Bill, 2014
22	Tuesday, March 25, 2014	Child Marriage Restraint (Amendment) Bill, 2014
23	Tuesday, March 04, 2014	The Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2014
24	Tuesday, March 04, 2014	Hindu Marriage Act, 2014
25	Tuesday, February 25, 2014	The Criminal Law (Amendment) Bill, 2014
26	Tuesday, February 25, 2014	The Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University Islamabad (Amendment) Bill, 2014
27	Tuesday, February 25, 2014	The Control of Narcotics Substances (Amendment) Act, 2014
28	Tuesday, February 25, 2014	The Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2014
29	Tuesday, February 04, 2014	The Civil Servants (Amendment) Bill, 2014
30	Tuesday, February 04, 2014	The Code of Criminal Procedure (Amendment) Bill, 2014
31	Tuesday, January 28, 2014	The Constitution (Amendment) Act, 2014

32	Tuesday, January 28, 2014	The Constitution (Amendment) Act, 2014
33	Tuesday, January 28, 2014	The Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2014
34	Tuesday, January 28, 2014	The Education of the Holy Quran according to recitation by sighting and with translation, learning by heart and with correct pronunciation Bill, 2014
35	Tuesday, December 17, 2013	The Constitution (Amendment) Act, 2013
36	Tuesday, December 17, 2013	The Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2013
37	Tuesday, December 10, 2013	Code of Criminal Procedure (Amendment) Act, 2013
38	Tuesday, November 12, 2013	The Ratification of International Treaties Act, 2013
39	Tuesday, September 17, 2013	The Publication of the Holy Quran (Elimination of Printing and Recording Errors) Act, 2013
40	Tuesday, September 17, 2013	The Political Parties Order (Amendment) Bill, 2013
41	Tuesday, September 17, 2013	The National Database and Registration Authority (Amendment) Act, 2013
42	Tuesday, September 17, 2013	HIV/AIDS (Safety and Control) Act, 2013
43	Tuesday, September 17, 2013	The Islamabad Capital Territory Local Government Act, 2013



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